

# Qinema User Manual

A screening player for film events — version 1.0

Qinema 1.0 · macOS 13+

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# 1. What is Qinema?

Qinema plays a programme of films in order on an external monitor or projector, with smooth fades, and returns to a standby screen between sections. It is built for small film screenings and runs entirely offline.

- Films are grouped into **sections**. Each section is started by hand; the enabled films inside it then play automatically, one after another.
- Each film has its own **fade-in**, **fade-out** and **gap** before the next film.
- After a section ends the output returns to the **standby screen** (black by default, or an image / looping video you choose).
- Videos are shown at their native resolution; the output scale is displayed while playing.
- Everything for one screening lives in a **screening folder** with a `.qinema` file, so it can be moved or backed up as a whole.

# 2. Getting started

1. Open the DMG and drag **Qinema** to **Applications**.
2. First launch: Qinema is not notarized yet. Right-click (or Control-click) the app, choose **Open**, then **Open** again. You only need to do this once.
3. Choose **File ▸ New Screening…** and pick or create a folder. Copy your films into that folder (or anywhere — paths are stored relative to the folder when possible).
4. Click **Add Films…** at the bottom of a section and choose your video files. Add more sections with **Add Section**.
5. Connect the projector or external monitor. By default Qinema uses an external display if one exists, otherwise a test window.
6. Press **Start Program** to open the output on the standby screen, then **Play** or a section's **Play Section**.

# 3. The main window

The window has two modes, switched at the top: **Edit** (arrange and adjust) and **Show** (operate during the screening).

- **Film rows** show the title, enable checkbox, fade-in, fade-out and gap. The enable checkbox decides whether the film plays.

- **Rename** a section or film by clicking its text; click anywhere else to finish typing. Click the rest of a row to select the film.
- **Select several films** with ⌘-click or Shift-click, then remove them together; one confirmation covers all of them. Every delete asks for confirmation. The film currently playing cannot be removed.
- **View modes**: compact list, or a list with thumbnails.
- **Reorder** films by dragging, or with the Move Up / Move Down commands in the row's menu. Edits made during a screening are picked up for films that have not started yet.
- The **status area** shows what is playing, what is up next, the video resolution → output scale, and the progress bar.

## 4. Running a screening

- **Start Program** — open the output on the standby screen and return the "next film" to the very beginning. **Reset to Beginning** does the same during standby.
- **Play** — plays the selected film, or the planned next film if nothing is selected. After a film, the following enabled films of that section play automatically.
- **Play Section** — starts a section from its first enabled film.
- **Next** — fades out the current film and goes to the next one. If you select another film (a past one, or one in another section) the button becomes **Go to "title"**.
- **Pause / Resume**, and a seek slider in Edit mode.
- **Back to Standby (⌘B)** — emergency return. Fades out immediately and shows the standby screen. No confirmation. The interrupted film becomes the next film.
- **Esc** — closes the output screen immediately, with no confirmation (playback stops; use Resume afterwards).
- **Resume** — after an unexpected quit, a button offers to continue from the last saved position.

**Master timeline.** The planned order is always the reference. With nothing selected, or the playing film selected, "Next" follows the plan. Any jump outside the plan — to another film or section, "Next" during playback — shows a single confirmation dialog. You can turn this dialog off in Preferences.

**Fades.** A film fades in from black. At the end, the **last frame is held** and fades out to black (audio fades too), then the gap runs. For the last film of a section, the standby screen cross-fades in while the last frame fades out (Project Settings ▸ Transitions).

## 5. Level Mixer (⌘L)

Use the Level Mixer to even out loudness between films. It shows left/right meters and the waveform of the selected film, and a per-film gain parameter that can be changed while the film plays.

- **Measure All** analyses every film and shows its loudness. **Match to Quietest** lowers louder films to the level of the quietest enabled film. **Reset All** returns every gain to 0 dB.
- Gain can only **reduce** volume (never above 0 dB), so quiet films stay as they are and loud films are lowered.
- The master volume slider in the main window affects everything.

## 6. Test mode

Turn on **Test Mode** (⌘T) to rehearse the whole flow quickly. Each film plays only its first N seconds, skips to the last N seconds, and gaps shrink to 2 seconds. While a skip happens, an orange notice in the status area tells you which part was skipped (for example “TEST MODE: skipped 0:10 → 27:26”). Set N in Project Settings ▸ Test Mode. Test mode is never saved — always check it is off before the show.

## 7. Settings

- **Preferences (⌘,)** — this Mac: language (English / 日本語), confirmation dialogs on or off, output display, video scaling (fit / fill), audio output device, open the output at launch, the emergency key (⌘ + one letter), and global shortcuts.
- **Project Settings (⇧⌘,)** — this screening: standby screen (image or looping video, black by default), cross-fade, panic fade time, default fades and gap for new films, test mode seconds.
- **Global shortcuts** make Esc and the emergency key work even when another app is in front. This needs macOS Accessibility permission (System Settings ▸ Privacy & Security ▸ Accessibility). Without it, the keys still work whenever Qinema is the active app — including when the projector window has focus.

## 8. Keyboard shortcuts

| | |
|---|---|
| **Esc** | Close the output screen |
| **⌘B (changeable)** | Back to standby, immediately |
| **⌘L** | Level Mixer |
| **⌘T** | Test Mode on / off |
| **⌘,** | Preferences |
| **⇧⌘,** | Project Settings |

| | |
|---|---|
| ⌘N / ⌘O | New / Open screening |
| ⇧⌘S | Save as new screening |
| ⌘Q | Quit (asks if a screening is running) |

## 9. Tips before the show

- Run **Test Mode** end to end on the real projector, then turn it off.
- Use the **test pattern** to check that the picture is not cropped.
- Check sound on the real audio output device in Preferences.
- Keep the screening folder and the films on a fast internal or SSD drive.
- Disable notifications and sleep (Do Not Disturb / *caffeinate*) during the event.
- Keep a log: `~/Library/Logs/Qinema/Qinema.log` records playback and any stalls.

## 10. Troubleshooting

- **The output opens on the wrong screen** — choose it in Preferences ▸ Display & Audio.
- **A film will not play** — check the file still exists; the row shows “Missing” with a **Relink…** button (choose the file; other missing films in the same folder are relinked automatically). If several films are missing, use **Relink Missing Films** in the Edit toolbar and choose the folder that contains the videos — Qinema finds them by file name, including subfolders. Codecs supported by macOS (H.264, HEVC, ProRes, etc.) are supported.
- **Esc / ⌘B do nothing from another app** — enable global shortcuts and grant Accessibility permission. After updating the app you may need to allow it again.
- **macOS says the app cannot be opened** — right-click the app and choose Open (see Getting started).

## 11. About

Qinema is free software for personal and event use, provided as is without warranty. Requires macOS 13 or later. © Qinema.